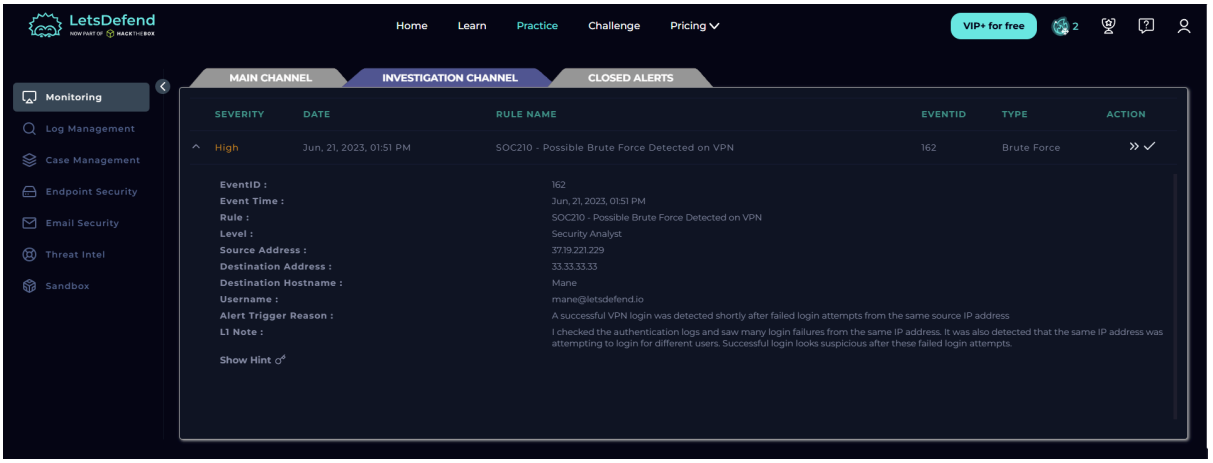
Title: Incident Investigation Report - [SOC210] VPN Brute Force
Date: April 19, 2026
Analyst: Alejandro Jasiel
Status: Closed / Resolved

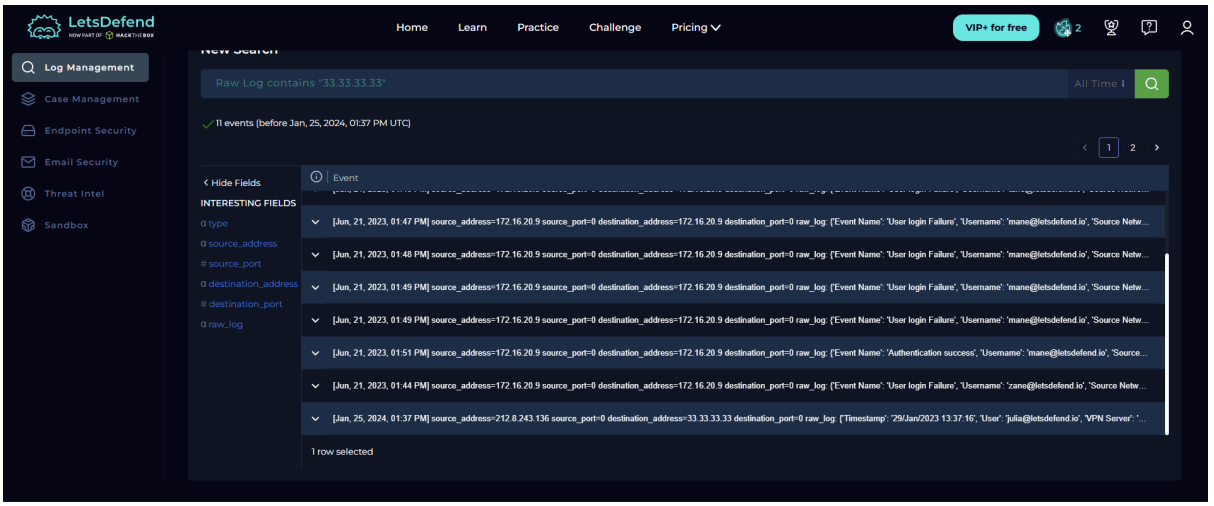
Executive Summary: This report details the investigation of a brute-force attack on the VPN service. While the alert initially flagged user 'Mane', the investigation successfully identified 'Julia' as the primary compromised account. Remediation steps included host isolation and artifact logging.

Step 1: Evidence of Initial Access (VPN Brute Force) - The Alert Trigger



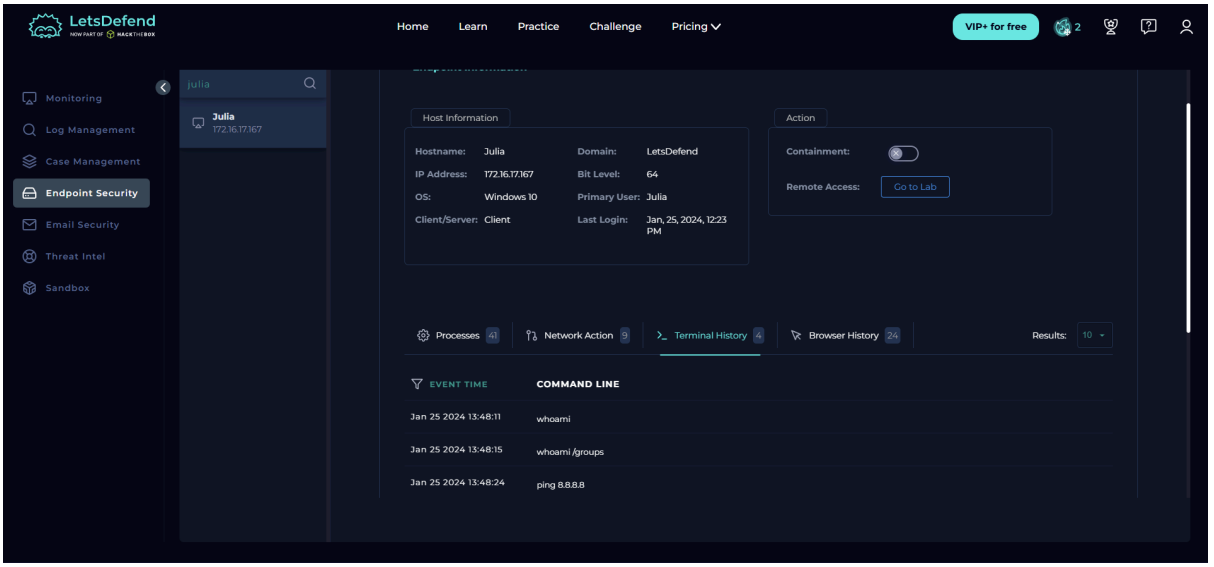
Review of the initial **SOC210 alert** indicates a suspicious **successful VPN login** shortly after multiple failed login attempts against user `mane@letsdefend.io` from source IP `37.19.221.229`. This triggered the automated detection rule for a potential Brute Force attack.

Step 2: Identifying the Compromised Account



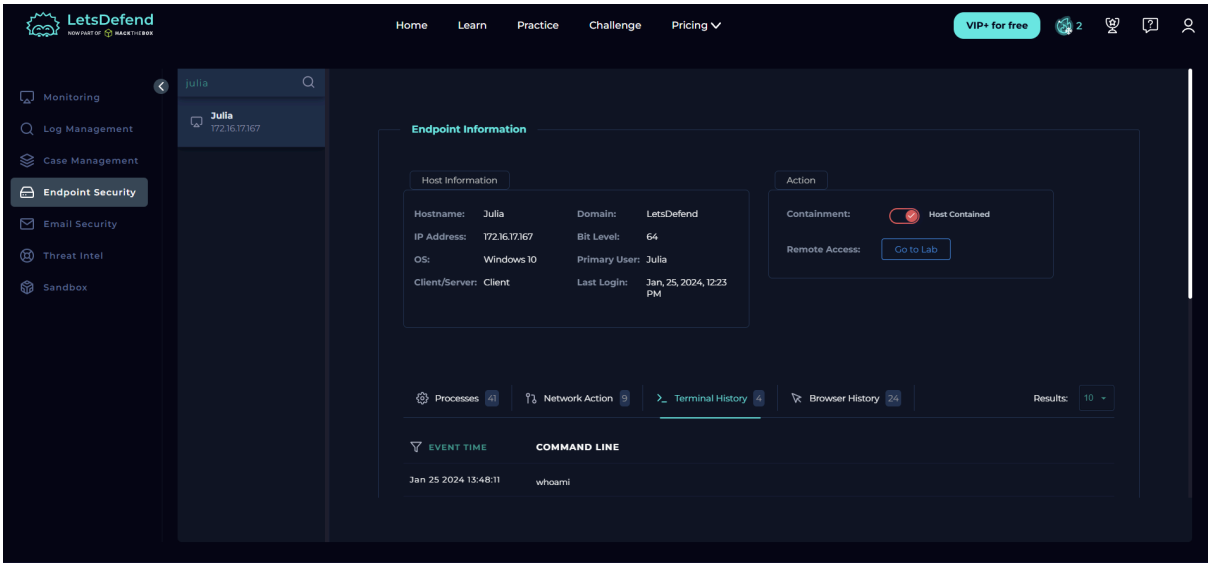
Upon deep analysis of the raw authentication logs for the malicious IP `37.19.221.229`, it was discovered that the successful logon was **not** against Mane, but was achieved against user **`julia@letsdefend.io`**. The attacker performed a dictionary attack, testing multiple common user names, and eventually obtained valid credentials for Julia. All subsequent activity was performed using Julia's compromised account.

Step 3: Post-Exploitation Activity (Host Compromise)



Further investigation into **Julia's endpoint** reveals post-exploitation activity. Following the unauthorized VPN access, the attacker executed reconnaissance commands (`whoami`) and critical malicious commands to disable security defenses. PowerShell was used to set Windows Defender Real-Time Monitoring to false (`$true`), essentially blinding the local security agent. This confirms a full host compromise via the compromised user account.

Step 4: Containment Action (Preventing Lateral Movement)



To prevent further access, data exfiltration, or lateral movement within the network, the compromised host (Julia) was immediately placed in **Containment** (Host Isolation) from the network management console.